

THE ELF QUEEN IS DEAD!

Now an Orb of Leafblood is needed to choose her successor. You, the adventurers, are a group of delegates from around the world assembled at the elven Great Tree to retrieve that Orb. It's a ceremonial task, a diplomatic mission, a great honor and not difficult.

A CONTESTED AGE

What will secure the future: the grace of the gods of light or the might of dwarves? Faith or fortresses?

A long night of undeath ended and a new age began when **Divine Emperox Xinyǎng's** holy warriors and sacred white dragons and **King Battlehammer's** stouthearted armies and Stonehearted Knights conquered the Necropolis and cleansed Omen.

But the alliance of humans and dwarves soon broke. Instead of drowning the Necropolis in the sea, as the King insisted, the Emperox raised the Lux Aeterna over its ruins and gave the island to the **Children of the White**. The King consolidated his hold on Omen and declared a protectorate in Glitterhaegen. What she rebuilt, he undermined. Where he sent his Stonehearted, she gave her Graces.

Half an age later, **King Battlehammer** rules the proudest, most prosperous, and most powerful dwarven kingdom in six ages. Forswearing his forebears' isolationism, he seeks a lasting peace through strength and curses Xinyǎng's weakness as boding another cataclysm.

From her Santa Cora Cathedral, **Divine Emperox Xinyǎng** presides over a resurrected Holy Dragon Empire. She evangelizes trust in the gods and an unarmored peace and fears that, in fighting the monster, Battlehammer became the monster.

Both vie for lands and souls across the world, including **Queen Moro-Lianae's**, who until her death fiercely maintained elves' independence while avoiding war. Now the world awaits news from the Great Tree...



CHARACTER/WORLD CREATION NIGHT

The first session, we'll fill in the world and your characters' OUTs, backgrounds, and icon relationships with juicy story possibilities. This will inspire your roleplaying and my NPCs and their plots.

- What has your character chosen: faith or fortresses?
- What faction and NPCs sent your character on this mission? Why did your character go?
- How has that faction shaped previous ages?

Feel free to work on your character in advance. Or do nothing to prepare. We'll work on the rest together.

RACES

Feel free to pick any of the races below.

Humans, Dwarves, and Elves have prejudices about each other, to say the least.

Forgeborn: Dwarves know the Stonehearted Knights won the war and now ensure peace.

Holy Ones: Humans know Speakers are rare but when they "speak" for the Gods of Light, they also heal.

White Dragonics: Humans know Graces, gifted from the Children of the White after the war ended, are apostles of pure compassion.

Halflings: Elves know sneaky little hobbitses are spies!

Alleykin (cat people), **Arcanites** (humans warped, augmented, transformed by or just exposed to way too much arcane power), **Beastblooded** (descendants of werewolves and other lycanthropes), **Fauns, Fairies, Gnomes, Half-Elves, Half-Orcs, Lizardpeople, Spiritborn** (half mortal, half elemental), **Tiefling, Trolls, Twzyyog** (fungus people), **Unholy Ones**.

How is your character's race perceived? Come to Creation Night with ideas.

CLASSES

[Dark Pacts & Ancient Secrets](#) classes are available, as is the Demonologist class from the [13th Age Book of Demons](#).

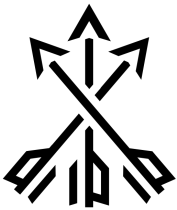
ICONS OF THE HOLY DRAGON EMPIRE

Feel free to choose any icons. Bring ideas about their goals and relationships to Creation Night. Why did elves invite that icon to send an emissary? What did that icon send you to do?



THE KING & THE DIVINE EMPEROX

rule superpowers, rivaled only by the other. They divide the world: faith or fortresses? All other powers have chosen a side—or no side, with its own costs.



OROMË THE HUNTSMAN

is the ferocious wood elf protector of the Elven Wood, vying to succeed Queen Moro-Līanae. He aims to forge an alliance with Battlehammer, ready elves for war, and expand their lands.

THE SILVER MASTER

is the charismatic cave elf holy man, vying to unite high, wood, and cave elves under his teaching. He satiates the brutal gods, purifies elven rivers, forests, and caves, and inspires his people to strict righteousness. Often more esoteric than sinister, he is favored by Santa Cora.



VARDA, STAR KINDLER

claims astral power not known among elves since the mystic-kings built the now-ruined Grey Towers. An outsider and a high elf, she vows to chart a course for elves by the stars, beholden to neither dwarf nor human.

CHILDREN OF THE WHITE

are the white dragon stewards of balance and paradox. Liberated from the Lich King by Xīnyǎng and revered as sacred by holy doctrine, they gifted her with white dragonic Graces. Others respect them as bringers of inspiration or fear them as sources of madness. Now they gather their lost siblings, but for what purpose?

WRAITH LORD

is master of ghosts and spirits but just a shadow of his late liege. Whether lauding Battlehammer or Xīnyǎng, all agree that liches, zombies, and all corporeal undead—and yes, even necromancy itself!—are extinguished forever.

FATHER OF SHADOWS

is a mystery. Parents tell stories of him to scare their children to obey. Respectable, hard-working people blame him as mendacious inspirer of all wastrel poets, bards, and actors. (Many of whom defiantly claim him.) Spies and assassins invoke him as patron. All with something to hoard or hide fear him. But who is he and what does he want?

GLAURUNG THE DREAD SAVIOR

is the greatest and most terrible of all gold dragons. Unattainably pure, mercilessly just, and unreachably distant, he leads orders of blameless to slay demons and sinners alike.

ORN THE MISBEGOTTEN

is the bastard of bastards and the only hope of the untimely born and disfigured, Orcs, failures, miscreants, and heretics. Many call him a noble brute, protecting outcasts and mocking the arrogant and powerful. Others, just a sadistic fool.

VALLANKUMOUS, LIGHTNING WITCH

is the grandmother of sorcerers and eldest sister of blue dragons. For a searing millennium, she was a catalyst of transformation, both magical and political. But the churn and chaos of the long night of undeath all but undid her. Sequestered now in her tower in Drakkenhall, she herself must evolve or fall.

TALHUIK, MOTHER DRUID

nurtures life, heals creations' wounds, and stewards an abundant and fertile earth. The Grandmother, her great river, carries the water of life to Santa Cora, and its delta blossoms with more grandeur, some say, than the Cathedral. Those who say so also warn that the underworld waters Battlehammer depends on are also Talhuik's.

DAEVOS THE CURSED MERCHANT

and his itinerant brethren will sell you anything your heart desires. Sometimes they accept payment in gold. The most ruthless bandit deals respectfully with a lone man on the road with a laden mule. To rob him is to tempt fate. To refuse an exchange? *Oh, but certainly you need something, my child! Dried meats, a knife, a length of magical thread, a promotion, a blood curse on your enemies? For you, I make a deal.*

HISTORY OF THE 13TH AGE

As recorded at Creation Night.

9TH AGE: AGE OF OMEN

THE O MEN'S ZENITH

With their silver tongues and moral suasion, natives of Omen interrupted the Lich King's Omega Ritual that threw the Midland Sea into turmoil. Called the Big Stop, peoples across the world sent grateful tribute, including the Black Pearl of Charlemagne and Black Diamonds of the Red Wastes. Giants sent a wondrous material called Snuwu.

Legacy: the O Men: O Men, the faction, endure.

GOLD SPEAR COVENANT MIND-MELD WITH O MEN

Narut Vilika of the Gold Spear Covenant and Jules (yoo-less) Pradlove of the O Men were the first to forge a mystical connection of shared memories and feelings. Soon greater numbers shared the connection, bringing the factions together. Though the mystic bond faded, a kinship already developed, creating tension with their allies, including between the Covenant and their icon, Orn the Misbegotten.

Legacy: Order of the Diamond: There remains an order of mystic clerics within the Covenant, called The Diamond. To this day, Diamond masters pass on the practice of mystical connection with O Men to their apprentices. Considered fools by the rest of the faction, they seek The Deep Bridge, which they believe is the powerful source of this mystic connection and likely a manifestation of some much earlier alliance or treaty.

9TH AGE ENDED

Massive storms and tidal waves across the Midland Sea destroyed trade routes and ushered in an age of isolationism and fear of the sea.

10TH AGE: AGE OF BLOOD

GOBLIN LIBERATION FRONT LEARNED "FAMILY" FROM THE DEFENDERS

Toejam the Wise learned the concept of *the family* as alternative to *the horde* when he witnessed The Wedding between Defenders. Defender's tutored goblins to organize as *families*. But it all went wrong when this transformation led the Defenders to sell goblins as slaves to icons all across the land. The Big Sell is remembered as a Goblin Diaspora.

Legacy: Mad Potato God: The Defenders sent each

goblin away with one potato, and the Cult of the Mad Potato God endures to this day.

THE OLD IMPERIAL HOUSE EXPELLED THE DEFENDERS

The Defenders served the Old Imperial House. But when the Defenders wanted to do something about Flying Castle, Emperor Bruffington VIII laughed at this and expelled the Defenders from imperial service. The Defenders constructed a small catacombs in this age, called The Reminder. Bruffington VIII is kept locked inside.

Legacy: Sigil Mastery: The Defenders mastered Sigil magic in this age, and built the North Tower Sigil Academy alongside The Reminder.

WAR BETWEEN THE CURSED SKULL AND THE GOLD SPEAR COVENANT

When the Gold Spear Covenant tried to evangelize and convert the people of the Necropolis, Orin the Corpsekiller disemboweled the leader of the evangelists, Thaddeus the Lighthorn. Orin and the Cursed Skull sent them back as zombies. When zombie Thaddeus and his zombie evangelists returned to the Cathedral, and the High Priest of the Sacrest Days mobilized a Gold Spear Covenant army in response. The war ended after grinding to a stalemate at the six-day-long Battle of Demon Coast. Thaddeus' uncle, Thanos Lighthorn, the supreme general of Gold Spear Covenant forces was slain at that battle. A peace accord was soon signed.

Lair: the Nightmare Marsh: The blasted and body-strewn field of the Battle of Demon coast became the Nightmare Marsh. To this day, it's filled with spirits, remains of the dead, and detritus of battle. It's a cursed and dangerous place.

DWARF CIVIL WAR AND THE SCANDALOUS RISE OF BATTLEHAMMER THE HALF-BLOOD BASTARD

When Dragon Emperor Bruffington VII's eldest daughter, Kyara the Sharp wed, dwarven Queen Stonewall was in attendance. Nurin Lightfoot--a commoner, an imperial footman, and an elf--caught her eye. Battlehammer was born nine months later. When Queen Stonewall died suddenly, her heirs took up arms, and Battlehammer won the civil war, a time called the Shattered Gem.

Legend: Blood Succession: Succession of all kinds and at nearly all levels of dwarven society is determined by a fight to the death. The victor is the Blood Successor.

10TH AGE ENDED

The dwarven civil war spilled across the land and embroiled the whole world.

11TH AGE: AGE OF BETRAYAL

THE DEFENDER'S ICON DISGRACED & DEFAMED

Daevos the Cursed Merchant out-witched the Lightning Witch. Lightning Witch and Daevos had an agreement: he protected the northern Iron Sea coast. But Daevos betrayed her, pillaging the coast and turned lands against her. Daevos' Pirate Captain Red Eye was especially hated. Everyone thought he served the Lightning Witch. All remember her as cruel and mad, but the Defenders know the truth and even now are trying to win back their trust.

Legacy: the Witch's Gift: The Lightning Witch enchanted the northern Iron Sea coast to protect villages there from spirits and wraiths. It's called the Witch's Gift.

11TH AGE ENDED

Volcanoes erupted, with gout of hellfire and demon-bile. Crops failed and famine stalked the land.

12TH AGE: AGE OF NIGHT, AGE OF DAWN

ONE EMPEROR FALLS IN FOLLY & ANOTHER RISES IN FAITH

At the start of the age, when Axis the great city sitting in the belly of a volcano *was not destroyed*, hubris seized the Old Imperial House. And lo, though the Lich King laid siege to Axis, Emperor Blad the Foolhardy led the Charge of Ronallon Fields astride his great gold dragon mount, Xoldex. They and the whole imperial army were slaughtered and soon rose as undead. Panic seized Axis. But one nun, Ani Xìnyǎng, brought calm in the chaos. She and her sisters gathered all the people they could into Axis' temples of light. These and the Dragon Throne itself were miraculously transported to Santa Cora in the Exodus of the Faithful. Ani Xìnyǎng was soon coronated Divine Emperox.

Legacy: Gods' Rescue: And thus it is said that in times of great requirement, one of true faith or desperate need can travel in gods' time from any holy imperial church, shrine, or temple to the Emperox's Cathedral.

THE GOBLIN LIBERATION FRONT NADIR

Much was lost in this age, including countless goblins killed in the Great War. With them died the dream that goblins could be anything but a horde. But surviving goblins took

refuge with Daevos the Cursed Merchant and were welcomed by his lieutenant Choadington. Through it all, the Goblin Liberation Front held onto potatoes and faith, especially potato growing rituals. Each potato patch has its own potato god. The Blessed Red Potato!

Legend: Gobtopia: A story endures from this age of a mysterious group of goblins called the Lost Family who refused the hospitality of the Cursed Merchant. Staying true the vision of goblin families, they settled in Gobtopia.

AN ALLIANCE OF MEN AND DWARVES

After the Lich King corrupted the island of Omen, natives hailed the dwarves, led by General Osmi the Bearded, as liberators. The Colasi was created at this time, a guerrilla unit of Omen-native resistance fighters and dwarf special ops, who landed in advance of the invasion. Once the O Men relied on their silver tongues, but in this age had to become militaristic, pick up weapons and use actions, not words. The scythe became the weapon symbolic of this transformation.

Lair: Chamber of Ba'lor: O Men and dwarves digging and using undermining as an weapon against the Lich King stumbled upon the Chamber of Ba'lor. Many dwarves died, and their special section of the Cemetery of Heroes is called the Great Tunnelers of Thalu.

ELVES ARE BROUGHT TO FAITH BY THE GOLD SPEAR COVENANT

Wartime cooperation between elves and the Gold Spear Covenant sparked a revolution in elven faith called The Great Covenanting. The gift that sealed the relationship came from the Gold Spear Covenant, who built hundreds of small shrines called Elven Ancestor Fanes across the elven wood that claimed traditional elven religion as part of the human pantheon. It all went wrong, however, because it lacked Queen Moro-Lianae's blessing. The shadowy AntiFanists led by a cave elf crypticly named Grey Rune were widely thought to be supported by her.

Legend: Saint Sybileth and Astarwë: Elves still sing the heartbreaking Ballad of Saint Sybileth and Astarwë, a tale of star-crossed love between a Gold Spear Covenant evangelist and a young traditionalist elf and the enchanted Rings of Lost Love they exchanged.

GOLD SPEAR COVENANT CROSSOVER WITH TBD

While the vast majority of the Covenant refused even to acknowledge the divide with elves, Covenanter Sylvia Traegen assembled a shadowy task force to work with them. Her goal, collaboratively to rebuild Ancestor Fanes in ways that would be more pleasing to them. But she soon learned these AntiFanists just want to watch the world burn. Meanwhile, elves and Covenanters alike remember

Tumin the cunning Gold Spear warrior who, at the Battle of Five Seasons in the Giantwalk, turned the tide of battle against Lich King forces.

Legacy: the Parchment Circle: Sylvia herself continues to lead a group of Gold Spear Covenanters and elves who, to this day, gather to read scriptures together.

THE CURSED SKULL NADIR

In their time of weakness and disarray after the Lich King was destroyed, the Cursed Skull were preyed upon by the Divine Emperox's necromancer-hunting Halos, led by the Godhand. But the foundation for the Cursed Skull's return was laid when Drogo Rottmaw took the reigns. Aware of the danger to the whole organization when Revan was beheaded, Rottmaw took the Cursed Skull underground. And seeds of doubt were planted between dwarves and humans.

Lair: The Lich King's Tomb: The Cursed Skull carried the remains of their fallen lord to Drakkenhall, where they created The Lich King's Tomb. It became rallying point for the faction.

12TH AGE ENDED

The age ended with the destruction of Necropolis.

FACTION	ICON	9TH AGE (4)	10TH AGE (3)	11TH AGE (2)	12TH AGE (1)
<i>Goblin Liberation Front (Chris)</i>	<i>Orn the Misbegotten</i>		Crossover with Defenders		Nadir
<i>Gold Spear Covenant (Hans)</i>	<i>Divine Emperox Xīnyǎng</i>	Crossover with O Men			Crossover
<i>Defenders (Matt)</i>	<i>Lightning Witch</i>		Crossover with Old Imperial House	Iconic	
<i>O Men (Mike)</i>	<i>Children of the White</i>	Zenith			Crossover with Dwarves
<i>Cursed Skull (Tandy)</i>	<i>Wraith Lord</i>		Crossover with the Gold Spear Covenant		Nadir
<i>Elves (GM)</i>	<i>Queen Moro-Līanae</i>				Crossover
<i>Dwarves (GM)</i>	<i>King Battlehammer</i>		Iconic		
<i>Old Imperial House (GM)</i>	<i>Old Emperor</i>				Iconic